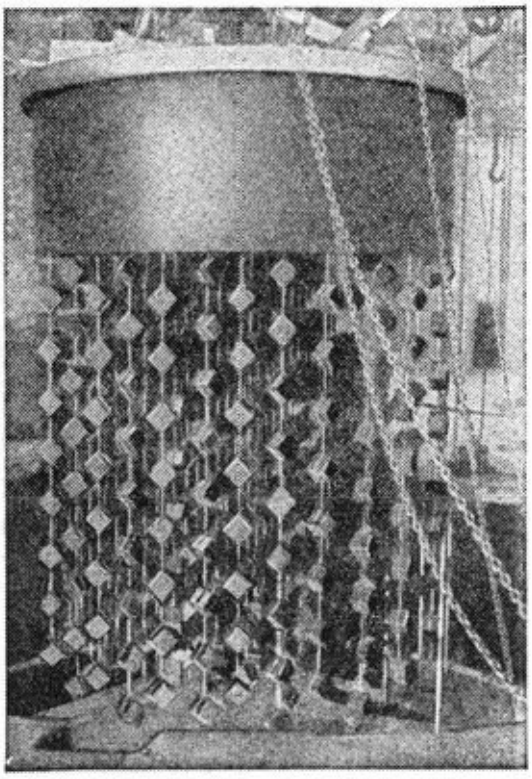


Figure 40A.—Interior of model of uranium pile.

The first uranium reactor large enough to yield energy built in Chicago, under the direction of Fermi, in 1942. ] built of uranium and graphite and began to react in Dece 1942.

When the chain reaction has begun, the uranium pile up nuclear energy in the form of heat: the uranium simpl hot. If it is desired to utilize the energy further technically, the heat must be removed in some way. This involves a number of technical problems which have still not been solved satisfactorily enough to permit the construction of an economically perfect power station based on nuclear energy. But this is just a question of time; sooner or later there are bound to exist power stations, stations for generating and transmitting heat, and naval engines, driven by nuclear energy.